rm Command in Linux

Interactive Notes with Examples

Syntax

The basic syntax of rm command is:

```
rm [options] file_name
```

Options

Option	Description
-i	Interactive mode (asks before deleting)
-f	Force delete (no prompt, ignore errors)
-r / -R	Recursive delete (delete directories and contents)
-v	Verbose (show files as they are removed)

Examples

Remove a file

```
rm file.txt
```

Remove multiple files

```
rm file1.txt file2.txt file3.txt
```

Remove all .log files

```
rm *.log
```

Interactive delete

```
rm -i file.txt
```

Verbose delete

```
rm -v file.txt
```

Force delete

```
rm -f file.txt
```

Recursive delete

```
rm -r my_folder/
```

Recursive + Force

```
rm -rf my_folder/
```

Recursive + Verbose

```
rm -rv my_folder/
```

Delete multiple directories

```
rm -rf folder1/ folder2/
```

Dangerous Command

■■ Never run this command:

```
rm -rf /
```

Pro Safety Tip

You can make rm safer by using an alias in your shell config:

```
alias rm='rm -i'
```

Summary

- Use `rm file` → delete a file
- Use `rm -i` → safe delete (asks confirmation)
- Use `rm -r` → delete a directory
- Use `rm -rf` → delete directory forcefully (■■ careful!)
- Use `rm -v` → show what’s being deleted